

The RSVP Clause: One Pager and Cast Suggestions

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One pager

THE RSVP CLAUSE · Written by Kelly R. Tenney · NCCA Entertainment

Logline. When Chicago’s most controlled wedding planner is assigned her ex-fiancé’s wedding, she signs a seven-rule fake-dating contract with a charming designer who never stays anywhere. Every event breaks a rule, and her Mexican-American family in Pilsen sees through all of it.

Tagline. Seven rules. One expiration date. Every rule breaks.

At a glance	
Genre	Romantic comedy
Format	Feature, 95 to 100 minutes
Rating	PG-13
Setting	Chicago: Pilsen, Logan Square, Streeterville, the River
Audience	Adult rom-com fans, couples, women 18 to 49, Latino households
Status	Third draft spec, available

The story. Chloe Martinez plans perfect weddings and keeps her own life in a color-coded calendar with no room for herself. Her firm offers her partnership if she delivers the biggest wedding of the year. The groom is Nate, the fiancé who left her three weeks before their own.

Ben Carter is a designer who has never kept anything for a whole year. After he panics and calls Chloe his girlfriend at a reception, they write the RSVP Clause: seven rules, one expiration date, no feelings. A quinceañera, a funeral, a baby shower and a midnight riverboat break the rules one by one. Her grandmother reads the truth in a single dance.

Chloe makes partner on her own terms, then finds Ben's apartment in boxes for a New York job he hid for months. To find each other again, she has to ask instead of deciding his answer. He has to choose a life that stays.

The Clause.

1. No kissing on the lips.
2. No deep conversations after midnight.
3. No remembering personal details.
4. No PDA beyond necessary hand holding.
5. No falling in love.
6. Either party can walk.
7. No one learns it started as a contract.

Term: expires at midnight after the Bishop wedding.

Why it works.

- A device every rom-com fan knows, set in the worst possible room: planning your ex's wedding.
- A specific, funny, load-bearing family: a Pilsen panadería, Sunday dinners, and a grandmother ordained online.
- Set pieces built for a trailer: the riverboat kiss at midnight, a 3 AM signage rescue, a baby-shower game that goes silent.
- Adult growth on both sides. She keeps her plans but shares them. He learns to stay and show up.

Comparable titles. *To All the Boys I've Loved Before* meets *Always Be My Maybe*, with the family comedy of *My Big Fat Greek Wedding*.

Package. Third draft spec. No cast or director attached. Produced by NCCA Entertainment, led by KT: more than 20 years in film and television, Co-Producer on nine seasons of *One Tree Hill*, DGA and IATSE.

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Cast suggestions: leads

Chloe carries the package, so cast her first, then chemistry-read Ben against her.

Role	Who they are	Suggestions	Why
Chloe Martinez, 30	Chicago's most controlled wedding planner. Mexican-American, raised in her family's Pilsen bakery. Funny under pressure, terrified of being left.	Melissa Barrera · Ariela Barer · Jessica Marie Garcia	Barrera has range across musical, horror and romance (<i>In the Heights</i> , <i>Scream</i>) and Mexican roots. Barer brings sharp, grounded intensity (<i>How to Blow Up a Pipeline</i>). Garcia has warm comic timing and a loyal audience (<i>On My Block</i>).
Ben Carter, 32	Charming freelance designer who leaves before he can be left. Notices everything about everyone except himself.	Nicholas Galitzine · Leo Woodall · Charles Melton	Galitzine is a proven streaming rom-com lead (<i>Red, White and Royal Blue</i> , <i>The Idea of You</i>). Woodall plays tender heartbreak beautifully (<i>One Day</i>). Melton brings warmth and depth (<i>May December</i>).

Star reach. Glen Powell for Ben if a buyer wants marquee rom-com value (*Anyone But You*). He plays older than the page, which works if Chloe is cast in her early thirties.

Cast suggestions: supporting

The Martinez family is the movie's secret weapon. Marisol and Rosa are the two supporting roles most worth a name.

Role	Who they are	Suggestions	Why
Marisol Martinez, 58	Chloe's mother. Runs the panadería like a general. Loves through food and pointed questions.	Constance Marie · Eva Longoria · Kate del Castillo	Marie is a beloved Mexican-American screen mom (<i>George Lopez</i> , <i>Selena</i>). Longoria adds star value and producing clout; the role can play younger. Del Castillo brings commanding dramatic weight.
Grandma Rosa, 80	Barely speaks, sees everything, ordained online. Steals the movie.	Adriana Barraza · Angélica María	Barraza is an Oscar nominee (<i>Babel</i>) who can carry a scene in silence. Angélica María is a Mexican screen icon with deep audience love.
Tío Hector, 60s	A mustache with a man attached. Challenges everyone to everything.	George Lopez · Cheech Marin	Both bring comic stature and family-party energy. Marin plays older; Hector can age up.
Tía Lupe, 60s	Feeds everyone, says what Marisol won't.	Chicago casting	A strong role for Chicago's Latino theater community, such as Teatro Vista and the Goodman ensembles.
David Chen, 33	Ben's roommate. A therapist nobody asked for, and the most honest friend in the movie.	Justin H. Min · Ronny Chieng · Bowen Yang	Min has understated warmth (<i>After Yang</i>). Chieng has razor deadpan. Yang has comic precision (<i>Saturday Night Live</i>).
Diane Whitlock, 55	Founding partner. Cashmere in August. Picked the door over a life in Lisbon.	Connie Britton · Jane Krakowski · Sarah Paulson	Each can play cool authority with a buried regret and land a joke without trying.

Role	Who they are	Suggestions	Why
Nate Bishop, 33	The ex who finally owns his cowardice. Must stay likable.	Jack Quaid · Logan Lerman	Both bring decency and nerves, so the audience forgives him without rooting for him.
Whitney Hale, 29	The warm bride who wants the taco truck.	Haley Lu Richardson · Madelyn Cline	Bright, sincere and funny, with enough spine to push back on her mother.
Cynthia Hale, 60	Sends back water. Eats tacos with a knife and fork.	Allison Janney · Jane Lynch	Both are comic heavyweights who make an imperious mother a highlight.
Richard Carter, 63	Ben's father, sitting alone in a truck.	Kyle Chandler · Bob Odenkirk	Both can play quiet loneliness that says everything with almost no dialogue.
Juniper, 24	Chloe's anxious assistant, who ends up with the earpiece.	Paulina Chávez · Chase Sui Wonders	Both have quick comic energy and a breakout role on the way up.

Casting strategy

Anchor Chloe, protect the family's authenticity, and verify everyone before outreach.

- **Order.** Cast Chloe first, then chemistry-read Ben. Marisol and Rosa come next; they sell the family to a buyer.
- **Authenticity.** Cast the Martinez family as Mexican or Mexican-American wherever possible. Marisol, Rosa, Hector and Lupe need fluent Spanish.
- **Ben's background follows the casting.** The Carter family is the script's thinnest world. Once Ben is cast, write his family's texture to fit the actor.
- **Chicago bench.** Cast the Pilsen extended family, the quinceañera court and the bakery regulars locally. It adds texture and keeps the production efficient.
- **Producer anchor.** An actor-producer for Marisol, such as Eva Longoria, can strengthen the package with a buyer.

- **Verify first.** These suggestions are based on public credits as of mid 2026. No one has been approached. Confirm availability, representation and current projects before any outreach.